CONTENT SYSTEMS.AI

The 10-minute store safety check

For e-commerce teams after the PHP2Shell bugs. Run it once now, then before every peak. You don't need to be technical: most of it is 3 questions to the people who run your site.

2 bugs

Called PHP2Shell. They let an attacker take over a web server without a password.[1]

Oct 21

The PHP Foundation released the fix. Anything not updated since is still exposed.[1]

Oct 17

Amazon saw the bugs being exploited about a week before the fix, so look for signs from this date.[1]

~70%

Of the web-facing internet uses PHP, including WordPress, Drupal and Joomla.[1]

1 TechCrunch, Oct 24 2026, techcrunch.com/2026/10/24/php-ocalypse-how-two-critical-web-bugs-almost-broke-the-internet

The fix exists. Make sure your store has it.

3 checks, about 10 minutes

Tick each box. If you can't tick 1, send this page to your host or developer and ask them to.

☐ 01 Ask your host or developer

DONE ON _____

ASK
"Was PHP on our site updated after October 21? Which version are we on now?" Get the answer in writing.

HOSTED STORE?
If your store runs on a hosted platform, check its status page or ask support whether its servers were patched.

NOTE
Write down the date they confirm. You'll want it if anything shows up later.

☐ 02 Update everything that runs your store

DONE ON _____

WHAT
Your store platform, every plugin and theme, and any old test or staging site still online.

WHY
Old copies of a site are the easiest way in. If nobody uses it, take it offline.

BEFORE YOU UPDATE
Make sure there's a recent backup you can restore.

☐ 03 Look for signs since October 17

DONE ON _____

ACCOUNTS
Admin users nobody on your team created. Remove them and change passwords.

MONEY
Payout or payment details nobody on your team changed, and orders or refunds you don't recognise.

FILES
Ask your developer for a list of files changed since October 17 that nobody can explain.

Found something? Don't delete it yourself. Tell your host or developer straight away, and keep notes of what you saw and when.

Want the boring work handled every day?

Content Systems.ai builds AI systems for e-commerce and logistics teams that watch the details nobody has time for, on the tools you already use, with your team approving anything that matters. Tell us about your store and we'll send a free quote with your top AI opportunities.

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